Excerpts from

The Overthinker's Guide to Making Decisions

How to Make Decisions Without Losing Your Mind

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TRUST Decision-Making Framework

The TRUST Framework is a tool to help you make the most actualized decision—the one that brings the greatest peace, growth, and alignment. Instead of falling into the trap of chasing the "right" choice, it guides you out of overthinking and into deeper self-trust, helping you choose from intuition so that your life is shaped by your truth, not fears. Because this is an exercise you'll want to come back to on a regular basis, I recommend you write your responses in a separate notebook or journal.

Take five deep breaths.

Regulate the nervous system by taking five slow, deep breaths. Try the two-to-one breathing technique: inhale for four seconds, and exhale for eight.

Reveal the root decision.

State the decision you are facing in one clear sentence. Don't include the possible outcomes or emotions, just the decision at hand. What event prompted this decision?

Uncover the fear and its cost.

What are you afraid might happen if you choose wrong? What do you worry that choosing wrong would mean about you?

What is this fear costing you?

Shift from fear to intuition.

Using the principles of SAGE, which choice will bring the most long-term peace, alignment, and growth—even if it feels scary to choose?

Suspend judgment and give yourself permission to consider this choice an actual possibility. How would it feel to choose this option?

If you release your attachment to outcomes and trust you can navigate whatever happens, what is your intuition telling you to choose?

Write down your actualized decision:

Take the smallest possible action.

What's the first small step you can take that will make this choice a reality?

Reflection

How did this decision feel? What did you learn about your thoughts, patterns, and fears? What did you learn about what helps you break through overthinking?

Reflection

Take a moment and go through the exercises you filled out and notice the patterns, shifts, and insights that have emerged. This is your chance to pause and witness what's changing and growing—not just in your decisions, but in you. Let this be a space to become mindful of what's working, what's ready to be released, and what's asking for more of your trust.

Progress Check-In

How much was overthinking present in these decisions?

CONSTANTLY — NOT AT ALL

1 2 3 4 5

How much did you trust yourself in these decisions compared to before this process?

MUCH LESS — MUCH MORE

1 2 3 4 5

How much were you able to trust that you'd be able to handle the outcomes of the decisions, even if they weren't the ones you desired?

MUCH LESS — COMPLETELY

1 2 3 4 5

How different does your decision-making feel now compared to before this process?

NO CHANGE — COMPLETELY TRANSFORMED

1 2 3 4 5

Self-Reflection

Which decision felt the hardest? Did you recognize any patterns in your thoughts or fears in those moments? What insights can you draw from these experiences?

What makes overthinking worse when making decisions? What helps you let go of overthinking decisions and trust yourself? How can you bring more of that into future decisions?

What did it feel like in the moments when you followed your intuition rather than fear? What did you learn from those experiences?

If this page marked the end of one old belief, story, or way of being, what would it be? What are you ready to leave behind?

How have you felt your decision-making change over the course of working through these exercises?

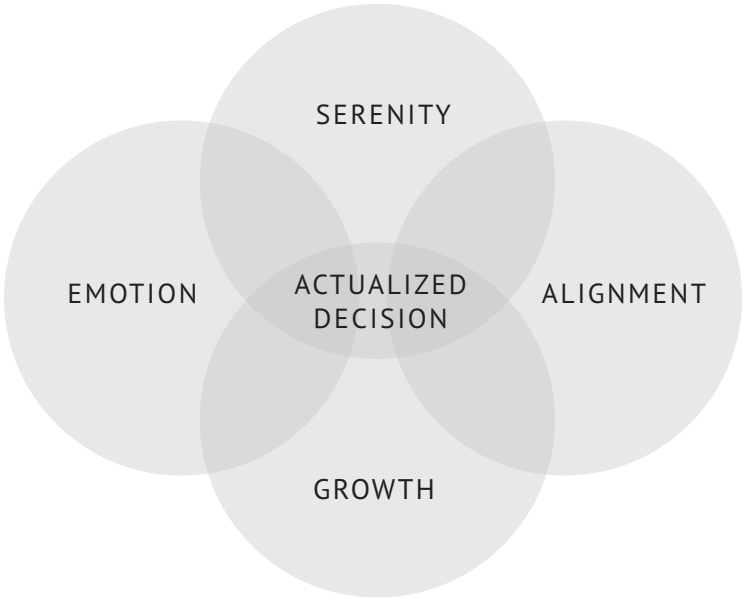
What do you want to remember the next time you're facing a challenging decision that would help you most?

The Dimensions of an Actualized Decision

SAGE

An actualized decision is a choice made not from fear, pressure, or the need for approval but from self-trust, presence, alignment, and love. It is the decision that brings the greatest peace and growth, not because the outcome is guaranteed, but because of who you become by choosing it.

Serenity—Which choice will give me the deepest long-term peace?
Alignment—Which choice aligns with who I want to become?
Growth—Which choice expands me the most?
Emotion—Which choice is driven by love and abundance rather than fear?



Decision-Making Principles

This is a collection of the most powerful, perspective-shifting truths in this book. These aren't just concepts to understand; they are waypoints to guide you. Lenses to see differently. Anchors to return to. Reminders of the deeper wisdom you already carry.

Read through them slowly—not just with your mind, but with your heart. Notice what resonates. What expands your perspective or gently shifts the way you think? What feels like truth?

Let each principle be more than advice. Let it be a mirror reflecting the version of you that already knows what to do when you tune into yourself. Come back to this page whenever you feel uncertain. Not to find the "right" answer but to realign with who you are becoming. The version of you who trusts yourself. Who chooses from love, not fear. Who makes decisions not to avoid life but to fully live it.

Fear & Protection

1. The root of overthinking is fear.
2. You're not stuck in indecision because you don't know what to do. You're stuck because you're afraid of what you will lose if you choose wrong.
3. Fear is an indication not that something is wrong but that you are on the verge of something right.
4. Fear is not a stop sign—it's a compass pointing toward what matters most.
5. Fear is not in the way. It is the way.
6. Fear and desire are two sides of the same coin. On the other side of fear is everything you're looking for in life.
7. Fear no longer controls you the moment you decide that your peace and growth matter more than avoiding what you're afraid of.
8. Every decision is either a step into fear or a step into freedom.

Intuition & Inner Knowing

9. The mind thinks, but intuition knows.
10. The mind will convince you that you don't know what to choose even though your intuition always does.

11. The best decisions of your life will never be found in the logic of the mind. They will be felt in the intuitive knowing of your heart.
12. The clarity you seek doesn't come before making a decision. It comes from making a decision.
13. No one else has to understand your decision for it to be right for you.
14. Give yourself the permission you keep waiting for others to give you.

Growth, Alignment & Choice

15. One of the greatest powers we possess is choice.
16. There are no inherently right, wrong, or perfect decisions—only ones that are aligned or unaligned.
17. At the heart of every decision is this question: Will this contract who you are or expand who you're becoming?
18. The best decision is the one that brings the most long-term peace, alignment, and growth.
19. The purpose of life is not to get it right but to grow. The weight of the decision lifts when you realize: No matter what you choose, you're going to grow.
    To create a life you love, make decisions based on what you want instead of making decisions to avoid what you fear.
20. No decision is final. You can always choose again.

Self-Trust & Emotional Freedom

21. If peace requires self-betrayal, it's not peace—it's people-pleasing.
22. The people who truly love you won't need you to abandon yourself to be loved by them.
23. Most advice is other people telling you what they would do—but they cannot tell you what's right for you.
24. Your focus determines your decisions.
25. Your focus is a mental magnet. What you place your attention on is what you attract more of in your life.
26. The emotion you make a decision from is the emotion you reinforce.
27. Attention is the architect of your reality.

28. No outcome is absolutely good or bad. Every outcome contains both positive and negative consequences.
29. We have power over *how* we make decisions but not their outcomes. Who you are is determined not by what happens but by how you respond to it.
30. Peace and confidence do not come from trying to control outcomes. They come from trusting that you will be able to navigate any outcome.
31. Ultimately, it's not the outcome that defines your path. It's your response that shapes your life.